Raising MoveInSync's Play Store rating: recommendation

To: Product, Engineering, Support · **App analysed:** MoveInSync employee app (`com.moveinsync.ets`)

Data: 20,000 newest public Play Store reviews, pulled 10 Oct 2026 with google-play-scraper. The analysis uses the 1,538 reviews written in the last 180 days (about 12 Apr to 9 Oct 2026), of which 423 are 1-2★.

Bottom line

The headline rating is healthy (4.64 from 114,843 ratings), but **recent written reviews average only 3.82, and 28% are 1-2★**. Reviews are polarized (996 5★ vs 384 1★; only 39 2★ and 41 3★), so the damage comes from specific failures, not general dissatisfaction. These fall into three groups, and almost nobody is replying to the angry reviewers (**only 1% of 1-2★ reviews have a reply**).

Do first: (1) reply to every 1-2★ review, (2) fix trip reliability (tracking, ETA, late-cab alerts), (3) investigate the weakest recent releases and stop disruptive launch screens and UI changes.

Where we stand

Measure	Value
Play listing rating (10 Oct 2026)	4.64 from 114,843 ratings
Average of 1,538 recent written reviews	3.82 (monthly average ranges between about 3.6 and 4.0, with no recovery trend)
Share of 1-2★ reviews	28% (423)
1-2★ reviews with a reply	1%
Weakest recent versions	v12.19.0: 3.58 avg, 35% 1-2★ (100 reviews); v12.17.0: 3.76, 30% (141). Best: v12.18.0: 4.11, 20% (65)

Note: the 4.64 is a lifetime average, including ratings without text, and moves slowly. Written reviews skew negative, so the two numbers are not comparable. I track the recent-review average and the 1-2★ share because they react to releases.

Why ratings are low

Counts are 1-2★ reviews mentioning each theme (a review can have several, so the lifts overlap and should not be added up). "Lift" is the rise in the recent average if those reviews had been 4★, an upper bound used for ranking.

Group	Theme	1-2★ reviews	Est. lift
Trip reliability	Live tracking / ETA wrong	56	+0.105
	Cab late / driver / route	55	+0.106
	Late or missing notifications	19	+0.035
	Cannot reach the driver	4	+0.007
App quality	Crashes, bugs, slow loading	68	+0.127
	Login / OTP / registration	41	+0.079
Booking clarity	Booking / roster bugs	61	+0.112
	Confusing UI change / banners	25	+0.046
Other	No support response	25	+0.047
	Unfair No-Show / penalty	10	+0.018
	Safety concern	10	+0.019

What reviewers say:

- **Tracking:** the most-endorsed complaint (8 helpful votes, v12.13.1) says GPS shows the driver in the wrong place, ETA is inaccurate, and pickup times are out of sync.
- **UI change:** a reviewer on v12.14.1 says booking became a 2-step process and they thought they had booked a cab when they hadn't.
- **Launch banner:** a reviewer on v12.11.2 complains that a full-screen banner appears on every launch, blocking the cab timing and tracking they open the app for.
- **Driver contact:** a reviewer says the driver doesn't respond, only an auto reply appears, and asks for a chat option.
- **No-Show:** low volume but high severity. A reviewer asks for a check-in reminder after the vehicle crosses the pickup point, because a missed check-in marks them No Show.
- **Rating prompts:** 3 of the 50 sampled low-star reviews complain about being asked to rate after every ride or about not being able to submit a bad rating. This is a small sample, and the keyword tagger has no theme for it yet.
- **Scope:** the same app also covers desk and seat booking, and some low reviews are about that (for example desk allocation disappearing). Decide whether it needs its own owner.

What to do, in order

1. Reply to every 1-2★ review (start tomorrow, no engineering). Owner: Support.

- Reply personally, within 48 hours, using the theme to route each case (tracking, booking, login). Avoid canned replies.
- Offer an in-app way to report the problem. MoveInSync's own blog credits personalized replies for an earlier rating recovery.
- Success: reply rate on 1-2★ reviews from 1% to above 80% in a month.

2. Trip reliability (about 130 mentions across tracking, late cab, notifications). Owner: mobile + backend.

- Log the gap between ETA shown and actual arrival for every trip, and review the worst routes weekly.
- Show "last updated" time and a low-confidence state when GPS is stale, instead of a confident wrong position.
- Add reliable pickup alerts: push, then SMS fallback; check delivery on Xiaomi, Oppo, Vivo and Samsung devices.
- Add masked call or chat with the driver.
- Success: median ETA error, share of pickup alerts delivered on time, and the tracking theme's share of 1-2★ reviews.

3. Release quality and app speed (68 mentions; weakest versions are the latest). Owner: engineering lead.

- Pull crash and ANR data for v12.17.0 and v12.19.0 and compare against v12.18.0, the best recent release.
- Remove the full-screen banner on every launch. Show promotions after the user has seen their cab.
- Add a release gate: roll out to 5-10% first and hold the rollout if the 1-2★ share of new-version reviews goes above about 30% within a week.
- Note that 152 reviews carry no app version in Play's data (36% 1-2★), so the version table does not cover them.

4. Booking clarity (61 + 25 mentions). Owner: product + design.

- Keep booking to one step, or add an unmistakable "Booked" confirmation with date, time and pickup point.
- Test UI changes with a small group before full release.
- Log any mismatch between selected and created booking dates.

5. **Login and OTP (41).** Owner: backend.
    - Measure OTP delivery time and failure rate; add resend, SMS fallback and a clear error message.
6. **Severity fixes (small volume, serious impact).** Owner: product.
    - No-Show: reminder when the vehicle reaches the pickup point, a grace window, and an in-app dispute button for the transport desk.
    - Safety: review how quickly SOS and night-trip complaints are handled.
7. **Ask for ratings at the right moment.** Owner: mobile.
    - Make rating optional and never block a low-star submission. Show the in-app rating prompt only after a completed, on-time trip, never after a failure and not after every ride. Send unhappy users to an in-app complaint form first. MoveInSync's own iOS write-up reports a rating lift after moving to an in-app prompt.
8. **Keep measuring.** Owner: whoever owns this report.
    - Run `run_weekly.sh` every Monday and share the dashboard. Alert when the recent average drops by more than 0.2 from the prior four weeks, or when a new version's 1-2★ share goes above 30%.

Assumptions and limits

- Public reviews cannot say why something failed. Engineering logs (GPS pings, push delivery, crash rates) should confirm each root cause before building.
- Only users who choose to write a review are counted, and negative experiences are more likely to be written.
- Themes were tagged with keyword rules, which I improved twice after spotting false matches ("hang" inside "changes", "late" in "too late in realising"). I labelled 50 randomly sampled low-star reviews with Claude's help (rule: the main complaint is captured and no tag is clearly wrong) and spot-checked the labels myself: 40 of 50 (80%) were tagged correctly. Most errors were reviews tagged "other" that describe the app not opening, not loading or showing an error, or ETA phrased as "waiting time", so the app-quality and tracking counts are probably understated. An LLM tagger is available in the pipeline as a more accurate option.
- Lift estimates assume 1-2★ reviews with a theme would become 4★. They rank fixes, are not forecasts, and cannot be added together.
- The Play listing showed 4.3 in some public snippets and 4.6 in others at earlier dates; this report uses my own dated snapshot (4.64 on 10 Oct 2026).

How I got here (tools)

google-play-scraper to collect reviews; Python (standard library) to tag themes and build the dashboard; Claude to help design the pipeline, improve the tagger and draft this memo; a single-file HTML dashboard (`dashboard.html`) for the "How are our Play Store ratings?" question. The pipeline refreshes with one command.

Method note: how I got to the recommendation

Question: why are MoveInSync's Play Store ratings lower than they should be, and what should we fix first?
Scope: the employee app (`com.moveinsync.ets`), with the satellite apps' ratings noted for context.

What I did

- **Collected the data.** I wrote a Python script using google-play-scraper that pulled the 20,000 newest public reviews (text, star score, date, app version, helpful votes, whether the company replied) and logged a dated rating snapshot (4.64 from 114,843 ratings on 10 Oct 2026). Reviewer names are not stored.
- **Chose the window.** I analysed the 1,538 reviews written in the last 180 days, because recent reviews show the effect of recent releases and the lifetime average hides it.
- **Tagged complaint themes.** Each review got one or more themes (tracking/ETA, late cab, notifications, booking, UI changes, login/OTP, crashes/slowness, support, No-Show, safety, driver contact) using keyword rules.
- **Found and fixed errors in my own tagger.** My first version put UI-change reviews under "crashes" because "hang" matched "changes," and counted "too late in realising" as a late cab. I read the sample quotes, fixed both, and re-ran. The counts in the memo come from the fixed version.
- **Checked accuracy on a sample.** I took 50 random 1-2 star reviews and marked each as tagged correctly or not (rule: the main complaint is captured and no tag is clearly wrong). Claude helped with the labelling and I spot-checked the labels. 40 of 50 (80%) were correct. Most errors were reviews tagged "other" that describe the app not opening or loading, so app-quality counts are probably understated.
- **Ranked the problems.** I counted 1-2 star reviews per theme and estimated how much the recent average would rise if those reviews became 4 stars. This is an upper bound used only for ranking, and the lifts overlap, so they can't be added.
- **Looked at releases.** I compared 1-2 star share and average rating by app version to find regressions (v12.19.0 and v12.17.0 are the weakest of the recent versions).
- **Wrote the recommendation** as a ranked plan with an owner, first steps and a success measure for each item.

Tools

Python 3 (standard library for tagging and the dashboard, google-play-scraper for collection); Claude (Anthropic) as an AI assistant to design the pipeline, improve the keyword rules after I spotted false matches, and draft the memo; a single-file HTML dashboard for the recurring question "How are our Play Store ratings?"; Safari and a spreadsheet app to inspect results and the tagged CSV.

Assumptions and limits

- Public reviews show what users feel, not why a feature failed. Engineering logs (GPS, push delivery, crash rates) should confirm root causes before building.
- Only users who write a review are counted, and unhappy users are more likely to write one. The 3.82 recent average and the 4.64 listing rating are therefore not comparable.
- Keyword tagging is a baseline. I measured its accuracy and the pipeline includes an optional LLM tagger for more accurate themes.
- I assumed the task concerns the employee app and English reviews from India; other languages and the other apps were not analysed in depth.
- Public sources showed 4.3 and 4.6 for the same app at different times, so I used my own dated snapshot.

Making it repeatable

`run_weekly.sh` re-scrapes, re-tags and rebuilds the dashboard in one command. I'd run it every Monday and alert when the recent average falls by more than 0.2 or a new version's 1-2 star share goes above 30%.

What I'd do next

Switch to LLM tagging and measure its accuracy, join review themes with ops tickets and trip logs, track time to first reply on 1-2 star reviews, and re-check the themes after each fix ships to see whether they actually fall.

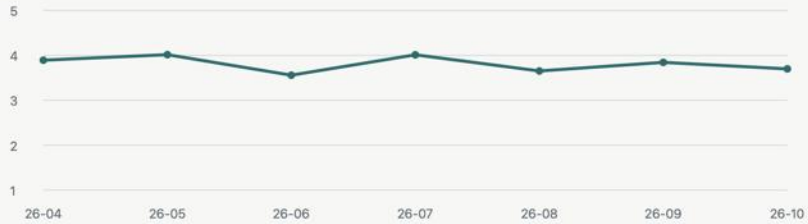
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How are our Play Store ratings?

App: employee · 1,538 reviews in the last 180 days · latest review 09 Oct 2026

4.64	3.82	28%	1%
Play Store rating on 2026-10-10 114,843 ratings	Average of recent reviews	1-2★ reviews (423)	1-2★ reviews with a reply

Average rating by month



What 1-2★ reviews complain about

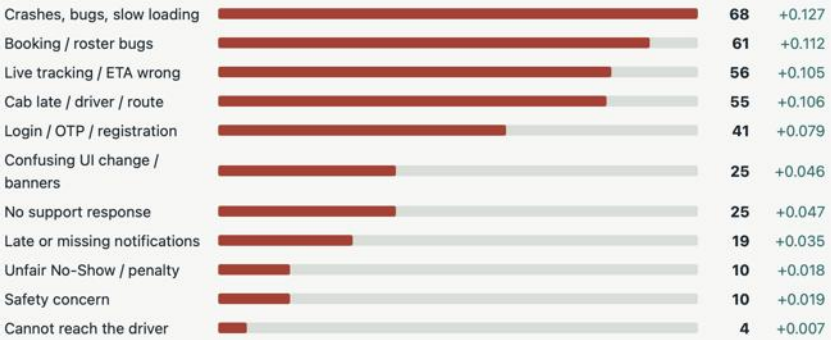
Count of low-star reviews mentioning each theme; the right column estimates how much the average would rise if those reviews became 4★. A review can have several themes, so the lifts overlap.

Crashes, bugs, slow loading	68	+0.127
Booking / roster bugs	61	+0.112
Live tracking / ETA wrong	56	+0.105
Cab late / driver / route	55	+0.106
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What 1-2★ reviews complain about

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Most helpful complaints

Crashes, bugs, slow loading

> Loading and showing full screen banner on every app launch is terrible. I am opening the app to see my cab timing, tracking etc. not to see repeatedly that it's earth month or something. You are wasting my time in loading and preventing me from seeing content that I use that app
> 1★ · v12.11.2 · 23 Apr 2026 · 3 found helpful

> There should be an option to directly search for seat number instead of using the map. There should be an option to set default floor in app and portal. Multiple times for multiple people, the seat number (booking shows but without desk allocation) gets removed for bookings which
> 1★ · v12.18.0 · 31 Aug 2026 · 2 found helpful

Booking / roster bugs

> The recent updates in the UI have made the app very difficult to use. Booking a shuttle is now a 2 step process previously it used to be 1. I got confused and thought I had booked a cab while I hadn't. Was too late in realising that. Such major changes need to be released in a be
> 1★ · v12.14.1 · 07 Jul 2026 · 3 found helpful

> Worst experience with this app, there is no perfect timing scheduled it changes very badly and when

time in loading and preventing me from seeing content that I use that app
1★ · v12.11.2 · 23 Apr 2026 · 3 found helpful

Cab late / driver / route

The GPS tracking system is often unreliable and sometimes shows the driver at an incorrect location, which can lead to unnecessary delays. In addition, the estimated arrival time displayed by the GPS tracker is frequently inaccurate, and the pickup time is rarely synchronized cor
1★ · v12.13.1 · 11 Jun 2026 · 8 found helpful

I had a suggestion to add a smart notification feature to remind the user for check-in after the vehicle crosses their pickup point. Sometimes, the vehicle arrives late or we miss by mistake to check-in, then we are marked as "No show" and it comes as a surprise. Introducing this
1★ · v12.14.1 · 29 Jun 2026 · 6 found helpful

Rating by app version

Versions with at least 20 reviews. A version with a sudden dip points to a release regression.

Version	Reviews	Avg ★	1-2★
12.19.0	100	3.58	35%
unknown	152	3.50	36%
12.15.0	83	4.04	23%
12.18.1	94	3.90	27%
12.11.2	143	3.97	23%
12.18.0	65	4.11	20%
12.17.0	141	3.76	30%
12.12.0	70	3.96	23%

Star distribution

5★ 996 · 4★ 78 · 3★ 41 · 2★ 39 · 1★ 384